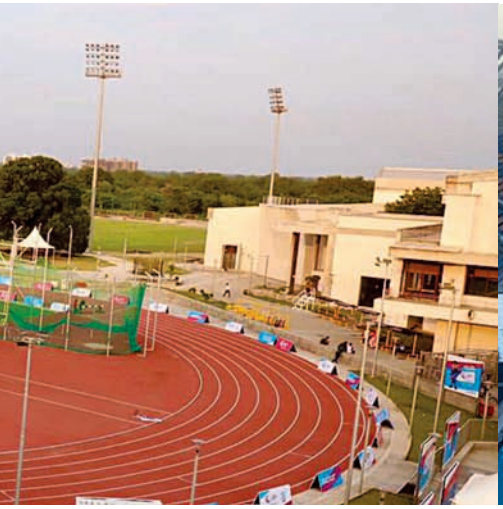
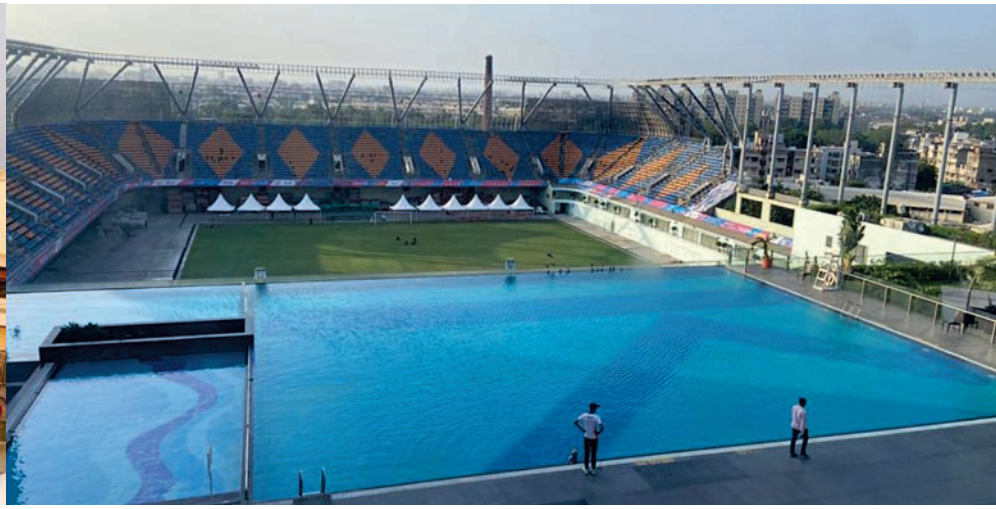




The policy, which has been implemented initially for a period of five years, focusses on 13 key areas which cover the range of initiatives that will be implemented towards the development of a sports eco system in the state of Gujarat. These are: Governance and Administration; Sports Infrastructure; Sports Goods Manufacturing; Private Sector Participation; Incentives, Rewards and Support; Sporting Competitions and Events; Excellence Programme; Support Personnel Development; Para and Special Sports; Upskilling and Reskilling of Athletes; Increased Participation; Ethics and Integrity; and New-age and Future-ready Initiatives.

The key objectives of the policy include promoting sports for all; building a fit and active Gujarat by creating a vibrant sports culture; enabling athletes from the state to win medals at national and international events; and achieving national leadership in the promotion of sports nutrition, sports medicine, and sports science.

With the Sports Authority of Gujarat acting as the nodal agency to implement the policy, the policy is already translating rapidly to action on the ground. The existing sporting infrastructure in the state is being upgraded as per national/international standards in a phased manner. Going forward, sports colleges will be set up to facilitate the journey of long-term athlete development for students passing out of sports schools. District Sports Centres will also be set up in each district over the next two years.

A major initiative to look forward to are the four High-Performance Centres (HPCs) and eight Centres of Excellence being set up across the state. The participation of the private sector will be encouraged in establishing both HPCs and Centres of Excellence.

## HIGHLIGHTS OF HIGH-PERFORMANCE CENTRES:

The four new HPCs will nurture elite athletes and provide training facilities of international standards to them. One of these HPCs will be specifically for the training of para-athletes. In order to provide personalised training and development, the HPCs will have a specialised team of physiotherapists, psychologists, nutritionists, strength coaches, and sports analysts at hand.

The policy also lays down a three-tier “elite athlete development programme”. Sizeable cash awards and incentives are also promised for sportspersons. Data analytics and sports science will be introduced in the curriculum of the Sports University.

The creation of infrastructure facilities will not only benefit athletes, but also those in allied sectors. The policy proposes the establishment of an industrial cluster comprising companies that manufacture sports goods. Thus, it will give a boost to Gujarat's manufacturing sector.

A Khel Mahakumbh sporting competition will be Asia's largest grassroots sports talent identification and development programme. There are many more such initiatives being planned and launched. Besides promoting new-age sports technology, an international centre for sports wellness and an entrepreneurship and incubation centre for sport start-ups innovations are being set up. Taking the old with the new, even as Gujarat will develop a school for E-sports it will organise and host state/national/international leagues for indigenous games to popularise these heritage sports.

All in all, Gujarat's Sports Policy will take care of everything related to the world of sports. With its implementation, Gujarat will race ahead in the sports arena not just domestically but at the international level as well.

The state of Gujarat is determined to successfully organise the 36th National Games in the Amrit Kaal of sports through public participation and involving local players to boost the local economy. Since the time when Shri Narendra Modi was the Chief Minister of Gujarat, sports in Gujarat are seen as a unifying factor. They are not considered an individual or team activity but a community movement. The successful organising of the 36th National Games in Gujarat is a strong reflection of that.

